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18th January, 1952.

Since our telephone conversation yesterday I have looked up the records of your talks with Mr. Dulles about Japan and Formosa. I enclose the text of the press statement agreed with Mr. Dulles on the 19th June, 1951 which explained, as you will remember, that the Peace Treaty left it to Japan, after she had become a sovereign state, to decide her future relations with China. You will remember that at Mr. Dulles's request this statement was never published though you informed the House of its substance on the 12th July. On re-reading it, I think you will agree that Mr. Yoshida's letter to Mr. Dulles does not contravene the letter of this agreement.

At the meeting in your office on the 4th June (i.e. just after Mr. Dulles arrived in this country) you agreed with him that the question called for much more study. It was a few days later, towards the end of his stay here, that the formula was agreed but it was not until the 19th that the draft press statement was agreed on both sides.

It is also relevant to recall Mr. Dulles's first speech at the San Francisco Conference in September. He then said that a possible

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The Right Honourable
Herbert Morrison, C.H., M.P.

course with regard to China might have been to have two Peace Treaties, each of which would be signed by one of the two Chinese Governments. He did not think that the Japanese Government would have agreed to this however, adding that "To exert a compulsion in this matter would create resentment in Japan and it would activate and aggravate Allied division in the face of a grave world-wide menace which requires maximum unity". He then said that, by deciding to exclude China from the Peace Conference, the Allies had left "China and Japan to make their own peace, on terms, however, which would guarantee full protection of the rights and interests of China". Though it might be fair to infer from these quotations that Mr. Dulles genuinely intended that Japan should be left free to determine her own relations with China after the Peace Treaty came into force, he does not seem to have given any categorical undertaking to this effect in his speech. The Americans will no doubt claim that this was a voluntary act by Japan and whatever we may think about that, we can hardly disprove it.

WILLIAM STRANG

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